

词汇: **traffic** 交通

- 1 Driving: do we love it because it's quick and **convenient**, or is it just that we don't have a choice? Either way, **commuting** by car is becoming more common across the world. While this could mean that people are getting more **mobility** and freedom, could it have a cost?
- 2 As the number of cars on the road increases, so does **congestion**. As more people travel by car, more road space is used up. According to the OECD's International Transport Forum, the average person travelling in a car takes up five times as much road space as someone on a bus. This is made worse by the fact that, on average, today's cars are larger than those of the past. **Tailbacks** and other **traffic jams** in the UK could be costing £7.5 billion each year in wasted time.
- 3 It's not just **gridlock** and wasted time that's the problem. Car dependency has significant health impacts. Air **pollution** from diesel and petrol cars can cause health problems such as asthma and other **respiratory** illnesses. Road traffic accidents lead to injuries and **fatalities**. Additional to this are the long-term problems caused by **sedentary** lifestyles, leading to poor fitness and obesity. Road-building developments can also split communities, leading people to feel **cut off**. Where road transport dominates an area, people without access to a car can feel **isolated**.
- 4 Cities and countries are sometimes tempted to build new roads to reduce the potential for **snarl-ups**. However, some experts say that this can cause **induced demand** where increased road capacity leads to more people driving, and congestion is soon back to its previous level. The other side of this theory is that when road space **allocation** is taken away from private cars, often congestion won't get any worse. Authorities in some cities, such as Seoul and Utrecht, have demolished **motorways**, leaving natural features such as streams and rivers in their place. Making drivers pay more is an approach used in cities like London, or Singapore, where ten-year car ownership licenses can cost over £60,000. The increased costs can help reduce the number of cars on the road and make traffic **flow** faster.

测验与练习

一、将标题和段落配对。

Paragraph 1 _____

Paragraph 2 _____

Paragraph 3 _____

Paragraph 4 _____

- a. Traffic and health
- b. Convenience at what price?
- c. Is cycling the answer?
- d. The cost of congestion
- e. Reducing dependency

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. Buses use road space more efficiently than cars.

- a. True
- b. False
- c. Not given

2. What does 'this' refer to in the following sentence? *This is made worse by the fact that, on average, today's cars are larger than those of the past.*

- a. wasted time
- b. bus passengers
- c. cars' need for space

3. Asthma can be caused by...

- a. road traffic accidents
- b. pollution
- c. isolation

4. People can feel cut off by...

- a. road traffic accidents
- b. respiratory problems
- c. roads splitting their communities

5. Singapore regulates traffic through

- a. high fees
- b. road building
- c. population density

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

1) _____ by car is increasingly popular globally. This can lead to 2) _____ which cost lots of money through wasted time. Increased pollution from static cars can lead to people developing 3) _____ conditions, such as asthma. Road traffic accidents can cause casualties and 4) _____. The solution to the problem could be through ways to reduce car 5) _____.

sedentary	ownership	gridlock
commuting		fatalities
mobility		respiratory

（答案见词汇表后）

词汇表

convenient	方便的，便利的
commuting	通勤
mobility	流动性，移动性
congestion	交通拥堵
tailback	（因拥堵而形成的）车辆长龙
traffic jam	交通堵塞
gridlock	交通大堵塞
pollution	污染
respiratory	呼吸的
fatality	死亡
sedentary	缺乏活动的
cut off	与外界隔绝
isolated	孤独的，被孤立的
snarl-up	拥堵
induced demand	诱导需求
allocation	分配
motorway	高速公路
flow	流动，移动

答案

一、将标题和段落配对。

Paragraph 1 **b) Convenience at what price**

Paragraph 2 **a) The cost of congestion**

Paragraph 3 **e) Traffic and health**

Paragraph 4 **d) Reducing dependency**

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. **a. True.** *According to the OECD's International Transport Forum, the average person travelling in a car takes up **five times as much road space as someone on a bus.***

2. **c.** *The pronoun 'this' refers to the previous sentence which says that people travelling in cars need more space than people travelling on a bus.*

3. **b.** *Air **pollution** from diesel and petrol cars can **cause health problems such as asthma** and other respiratory illnesses.*

4. **c.** *Road developments can also **split communities**, leading people to feel cut off.*

5. **a.** *Making drivers pay more is an approach used in cities like London, or Singapore, where ten-year car ownership licenses can cost over £60,000. **The increased costs can help reduce the number of cars on the road** and make traffic flow faster.*

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

Commuting by car is increasingly popular globally. This can lead to **gridlock** which cost lots of money through wasted time. Increased pollution from static cars can lead to people developing **respiratory** conditions, such as asthma. Road traffic accidents can cause casualties and **fatalities**. The solution to the problem could be through ways to reduce car **ownership**.